

Chapter 184 Part 1: Extra Story 7-1

After everyone left, Liang Shi accompanied Chaochao and Mumu to wash up, then went back to the room to tell them bedtime stories.

Mumu, who had been disciplined today, was especially well-behaved. Her eyes darted around as she listened to Liang Shi tell the story, and she wasn't as eager to ask questions as usual.

That night, Liang Shi told a fairy tale about a child who bullied a classmate and grew a long nose, only returning to normal after apologizing to the classmate.

This fairy tale was also made up by Liang Shi on the spot.

Yet it scared Mumu terribly. She hugged her sister's arm and looked at Liang Shi with an aggrieved expression.

But Liang Shi didn't go soft. She only said gently: "Tomorrow we'll see if Mumu turns into a long nose."

Mumu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu stood at the doorway, laughing silently.

She had thought Liang Shi was really so indulgent that she couldn't say a single harsh word.

Turns out she could still gently "threaten."

That was pretty good too.

Liang Shi only returned to the room after coaxing the two children to sleep. The moment she opened the door, she found Xu Qingzhu sitting on the bed reading a book.

This was Xu Qingzhu's bedtime habit.

A few days ago she had been reading a suspense novel, and the two of them had even read it together, even making bets on who the culprit was.

Liang Shi saw she had flipped to the back and asked: "Did you see? Who's the culprit?"

But hearing this, Xu Qingzhu suddenly raised her head eerily, her gaze like fire.

Those bright eyes stared straight at Liang Shi, giving Liang Shi goosebumps all over her back. "What's wrong? Why are you looking at me like that? Even if I guessed wrong, it's not that serious, is it?"

Xu Qingzhu slowly shook her head without saying anything.

Liang Shi pursed her lips and walked over to her. She rested her arm beside Xu Qingzhu, bending over while standing at the bedside, her upper body leaning forward, looking straight at Xu Qingzhu: "Who's the culprit?"

"You—guess." Xu Qingzhu slightly parted her lips.

Liang Shi lowered her head to look at the book, only to discover that Xu Qingzhu hadn't been reading the book at all.

Tucked inside the novel, opened up, was her new script.

The company's self-produced sweet drama that she had taken on per fans' requests, "Listening to the Wind Say I Love You."

Liang Shi had also only gotten this script not long ago and had only read up to the second episode.

It was indeed a new era sweet drama with a particularly fast pace.

First episode: kissing. Second episode: going to bed. Then eight episodes of extreme push and pull. Final two episodes: releasing the sweetness.

It could be called a textbook idol drama.

However, aside from the more explicit content in episodes one and two, there weren't many kiss scenes afterward. The sweet parts were all accomplished through subtle hints, plus some sweet nothings.

This was Liang Shi's first time taking on such an explicit drama, but based on the current platform's censorship standards, it probably wouldn't be filmed too excessively.

She had read two episodes and put the script in the drawer, not expecting Xu Qingzhu to find it.

Thinking about the scenes inside, she felt inexplicably guilty.

Liang Shi blinked and reached out to take the script, but Xu Qingzhu pressed down on it firmly without budging, blinking at her, "What? Can't I look?"

"You can....." Liang Shi said helplessly.

Xu Qingzhu lowered her head and continued reading, very seriously.

"Is this your next script?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi took off her shoes and got on the bed, sitting on Xu Qingzhu's legs with her own legs dangling. She leaned her body forward, lying on Xu Qingzhu as if acting cute. "Yes." As she spoke, she kissed her chin: "Baby, stop reading the script, look at me instead."

"Hm?" Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow.

Liang Shi: "....."

"Your next drama is an idol drama?" Xu Qingzhu's tone was a bit sour.

Liang Shi nodded: "Mm... I can act in it, right?"

"You've already taken it and now you're asking me?" Xu Qingzhu laughed lightly: "Is my opinion that important?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"This script... is pretty good." Liang Shi said: "The character is a bit crazy, and also has a bit of a split personality... I want to challenge myself."

"I don't manage that anyway." Xu Qingzhu closed her own book and set it on the table, only keeping the script to flip through. "Take whatever drama you want to take. You're an actress—you need to be professional."

Liang Shi: "....."

She somehow felt there was something behind Xu Qingzhu's words.

But Liang Shi leaned over and kissed her face again. Both her legs were already stretched out, putting almost half her body weight on Xu Qingzhu, yet Xu Qingzhu remained unmoved, continuing to read the script with her head down.

"Stop reading the script." Liang Shi reached out to take the script from her hands, but Xu Qingzhu raised her hand. Liang Shi grabbed at nothing, and since she had no real support to begin with and was afraid of crushing Xu Qingzhu, she had been holding back her strength. Suddenly thrown off by this move, her body immediately lost balance, and her chin came crashing down heavily, landing right on Xu Qingzhu's soft chest.

It hurt so much that Xu Qingzhu gasped.

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi reached out to rub it for her, but Xu Qingzhu swatted her hand away.

Liang Shi pouted and rolled over to lie beside her.

"Is this script that good?" Liang Shi asked somewhat sourly.

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "It's alright."

Liang Shi sighed. Her hand had already reached from under the covers to Xu Qingzhu's pajama buttons, deftly undoing one.

But Xu Qingzhu suddenly said: "Let me run lines with you."

Liang Shi: "?"

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"Let go of me." Xu Qingzhu said the lines from the script with a frown: "You're hurting me."

"Tell me where Wei Shuang is." Liang Shi got into character in one second, her tone fierce.

"That's not right." Xu Qingzhu corrected her: "You need to grab my chin."

Liang Shi raised her hand, two fingers gently pinching.

Xu Qingzhu continued correcting, "Not like that, use some force."

Liang Shi frowned slightly: "Your skin is already sensitive. If I use more force, it'll turn red."

"So what if it turns a little red." Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow: "When you're on set, are you going to worry about the actress's skin condition too?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"Teacher Liang, you're not cutting it." Xu Qingzhu shrugged: "Where's your professional spirit?"

Liang Shi: "....."

It was just an instant—Liang Shi's eyes changed, and she used force in her hand. But her expression was that roguish type, carrying a hint of casualness.

Those eyes were utterly cold and heartless. No one would doubt what she might do the next second.

Even if she killed the other person, even if she crushed their chin—it would all be expected.

Xu Qingzhu felt the pain and her eyes reddened in an instant.

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Liang Shi immediately relaxed her grip, calling out with some distress: "Baby....."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together.

"Does it hurt?" Liang Shi leaned over, her fingertips gently stroking over that patch of skin, feeling terribly sorry.

But Xu Qingzhu glared at her: "Teacher Liang, where's your professional spirit? Are you going to comfort your co-star like this too when the time comes?"

But Liang Shi didn't pay attention to her tone. She only focused on staring at the skin she had just roughly handled, pursing her lips and frowning. She immediately turned around and went to the kitchen to get some ice to put on it for Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu had originally wanted to take this opportunity to make a fuss, provoke her anger, and then continue with the scene.

But Liang Shi drew a very clear line and didn't care about this at all.

Xu Qingzhu was momentarily at a loss and could only stand there blankly, letting Liang Shi do as she pleased.

While applying the ice, Liang Shi explained: "She's not my wife, so why would I comfort her?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Liang Shi wasn't angry at all about Xu Qingzhu's earlier tone. Instead, she remained gentle and said patiently: "When we're filming, we need to have conviction. If today the other person was grabbing my chin, or beating me until I knelt on the ground, then I would need to act out that feeling and accept her actually hitting me, because that's what creates dramatic effect. But you're my wife, and we're just running lines. I don't want to treat you like that, baby."

That final "baby" made one's heart itch, and also made one's heart feel sour and swollen.

It made Xu Qingzhu want to cry, her eye rims already red.

Liang Shi leaned over and kissed her, "You're already afraid of people treating you like that. If I did too, you'd have nightmares tonight."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Liang Shi pulled her into her arms, wrapping both arms around her body, hands falling on her back, gently patting—tender and intimate.

Her voice was soft and beautiful: "Baby, I won't mess around with other actresses."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Perhaps because her voice was too gentle, Xu Qingzhu suddenly couldn't hold back and hugged her and cried.

When she started crying, Liang Shi became even more flustered, coaxing in a low voice: "Baby, why are you crying again? What are you crying about? Let wifey hold you."

"Liang Shi, you idiot." Xu Qingzhu's voice was choked, tears wiping onto her pajamas.

Liang Shi patted her back: "My baby, what are you feeling wronged about now?"

Xu Qingzhu wasn't crying hard—it was just that Liang Shi's behavior earlier had touched a slightly sensitive nerve of hers, so she cried.

Ever since giving birth, her emotions had become somewhat sensitive.

But it was all sensitivity in good directions—she had become more emotional than before.

Xu Qingzhu struggled free from her arms a little, tilting her head up to look at her, "I... I'm not jealous."

"I know." Liang Shi said: "My baby just wanted to cry, that's all."

Xu Qingzhu patted her shoulder once, reiterating: "I'm really not jealous."

"Then what is it?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu stopped talking.

Once that feeling passed, she suddenly felt she was being childish.

She had actually just seen that scene in the script and found it interesting, so she wanted to act it out with Liang Shi. Most importantly, after this dialogue came the intimate scene between the two characters.¹

She didn't know how it had developed into this.

The most crucial thing was that even though she had thrown a little tantrum, Liang Shi wasn't angry at all.

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So she felt sorry for Liang Shi.

It was almost laughable to say out loud.

Xu Qingzhu naturally couldn't bring herself to say it. She sniffled, pouted at Liang Shi, her voice especially aggrieved: "Wife~"

Liang Shi immediately stroked her back: "Baby, I'm here?"

"You pinched me and it hurt just now....." Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi was helpless. Looking at her expression, she couldn't help but laugh lightly, but leaned over and kissed the spot she had pinched earlier. Then her lips moved to Xu Qingzhu's ear.

Her gentle voice said softly: "Serves you right."

Xu Qingzhu pinched her waist, but said: "Continue running lines with me."

Liang Shi nodded, complying with everything she wanted.

Only this time she didn't pinch her hard. There was still a scene where she had to pin her against the wall, but Liang Shi still didn't use force.

Using the height difference was enough to perform this scene well.

The following plot was what audiences loved to watch—the prelude to the intimate scene.

But it seemed like the screenwriter wanted that hazy feeling, so the screenwriter hadn't written it very explicitly. All the intimate scenes in the drama were very subtle, only having those very sensual scenes of lips drawing close.

Liang Shi slowly leaned in against the light, all her breath falling on Xu Qingzhu's face.

Their lips were only inches apart.

"Tell me where Wei Shuang is." Liang Shi was still saying her lines.

Xu Qingzhu had a good memory and could remember most of it even without looking at the script. She followed along with her lines: "I don't know."

"Then what do you know?" Liang Shi changed her gaze, carrying a hint of fierceness.

Xu Qingzhu curved her lips into a light smile, reached out and grabbed her collar, instantly turning passive to active. Her lips drew close to Liang Shi's lips, "I know... you're very nice to kiss."

Liang Shi: "?"

That line wasn't in the script!

Xu Qingzhu even stuck out the tip of her tongue and gave a light flick.

Liang Shi: "?"

This couldn't be broadcast.

But because it was Xu Qingzhu, Liang Shi let her do as she pleased and cooperated herself.

Xu Qingzhu's hands wrapped around her neck, leaning close and asking in a low voice: "Wife, is my acting good?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi turned her body around, advancing step by step. Xu Qingzhu's calves touched the edge of the bed, her waist tilting backward, but Liang Shi gave her a light push and she fell directly onto the bed.

The bed even bounced a few times.

Liang Shi's knee half-knelt beside Xu Qingzhu's legs, her body pressing down continuously, her voice very soft, "So, do you still remember what scene comes next?"

Xu Qingzhu pursed her lips, the corners curving upward. Her tongue tip slid across her teeth, those slightly reddened eyes full of mirth. Her hand reached up and grabbed the collar of Liang Shi's pajamas, pulling down hard—Liang Shi's lips met hers.

Amid the brushing of lips against lips, Xu Qingzhu said softly: "The... intimate... scene."

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1. "船戏" (chuán xì) literally means "boat scene" but is Chinese internet slang for intimate/bed scenes in dramas or novels. The term originated from the idea that romantic scenes often take place on boats in classical literature and film. ↩